

ApprovalFlow

Release Process

Moving a change from a development machine to pre-production and production

This guide is for whoever changes and releases ApprovalFlow. It covers the path every change takes: a development machine (this PC or the dev server), GitHub, the pre-production server (vc-workflow) and, later, production. It assumes each environment is already installed.

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CHAPTER 1

The environments

Environment	Machine	Purpose
Development	This PC, and the new dev server (C:\dev\approvalflow)	Making and testing changes with npm run dev. Test data only.
GitHub	github.com/farookgolan/workflow	The one central copy of the code. Every change and every release goes through it.
Pre-production	vc-workflow (Azure VM), C:\apps\approvalflow	Installing a release and testing it before production.
Production	To be decided	Receives exactly the release that passed pre-production.

IMPORTANT

A change only reaches pre-production or production when you install a release there. Nothing is copied automatically.

CHAPTER 2

Release steps

#	Where	What	Command
1	Dev machine (this PC or the dev server)	Get the latest code before starting	git pull
2	Dev machine	Make the change and test it	cd server; npm run dev and cd client; npm run dev then open http://localhost:5173
3	Dev machine	Save the change to GitHub	git add -A then git commit -m "what changed" then git push
4	Dev machine	Mark a release (a new number each time)	git pull then git tag v1.0.1 then git push --tags
5	vc-workflow (pre-production), Administrator PowerShell	Install the release	powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File C:\apps\approvalflow\scripts\azure-vm-update.ps1 -Version v1.0.1
6	vc-workflow	Check health, then test	(Invoke-WebRequest -UseBasicParsing http://localhost:8088/api/v1/health).Content should print {"status":"ok","db":"ok"}; then sign in and try the change
7	Production (later), Administrator PowerShell	Install the SAME release	The same command as step 5, with the same version

TIP

Steps 1-3 can be repeated many times before a release. Commit and push as often as you like; tag only when a set of changes is ready for pre-production.

CHAPTER 3

What an update does

Item	Automatic?	Notes
Code (pages, server logic)	Yes	Downloaded from GitHub for the chosen version
Libraries (npm packages)	Yes	npm ci
Database structure (migrations)	Yes	New migrations are applied
Build, IIS, service restart	Yes	Through deploy-local-iis.ps1
Installed-version record	Yes	C:\apps\approvalflow\DEPLOYED.txt
Settings (server\.env)	No	Each environment keeps its own. When a change needs a new setting, edit the file by hand and restart the service.
Customer data (customers, users, requests)	No	Each environment has its own database; data is never copied between them.

CHAPTER 4

Rolling back

Situation	What to do
Bad release with no database change	Run step 5 again with the previous version, for example -Version v1.0.0
Bad release with a database change	Going back to old code does not undo the database change. Back up the database before updating, and restore that backup if needed. Database changes are announced before such a release.

CHAPTER 5

Rules and checks

Rules to follow

Rule	Why
Always git pull before starting work and before tagging	Keeps this PC and the dev server in step, so a release includes everything
Never edit code directly on vc-workflow or production	The next update overwrites it; all changes go through a dev machine and GitHub
Test on pre-production before installing on production	Production then gets exactly the version that was tested
If the health check fails right after an update, wait a minute and check again	The service needs a few seconds to start

Useful checks on vc-workflow

Check	Command
Which version is installed	Get-Content C:\apps\approvalflow\DEPLOYED.txt
Is the service running	Get-Service approvalflowapi.exe
Is the app healthy	(Invoke-WebRequest -UseBasicParsing http://localhost:8088/api/v1/health).Content
Recent service errors	Get-ChildItem C:\apps\approvalflow\server\dist\daemon*.err.log Get-Content -Tail 20